



Offline Spotify for WearOS

Spotify has finally announced that in the "coming weeks" WearOS will get support for offline playback. <https://digit.in/sep21-67>



5G rolled out in India

Ookla said that the 5G launch will enhance download speeds in the country by up to 10x. <https://digit.in/sep21-68>

Sennheiser Ambeo Soundbar

Can a single bar with thirteen drivers give an immersive Dolby Atmos experience?

Here, we have with us the Sennheiser Ambeo soundbar priced at ₹2,00,000. It not only boasts of a whopping 13 independent drivers, but also claims to create a room-filling surround sound experience without rear speakers. Is it the penultimate soundbar experience?

CONNECTIVITY OPTIONS

When it comes to connectivity options, the soundbar is pretty packed. You have one HDMI eARC port. There are also three HDMI 2.0a passthrough ports. The passthrough port supports 4K HDR including Dolby Vision. There is also an optical port, an AUX port, one USB port (for service and updates), one ethernet port, subwoofer out, one mic input, Bluetooth 4.2, and Chromecast connectivity. It also supports Wi-Fi (2.4GHz and 5GHz bands).

While the connectivity options are plentiful, there is no smart assistant that comes built into the soundbar.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Sennheiser Ambeo is quite massive and has a commanding presence in your living room/entertainment room. The device has 13 drivers – six 4-inch long-throw woofer (cellulose sandwich cone), five 1-inch tweeters (aluminium dome tweeter), and two 3.5-inch full-range drivers (top-firing). The front and side-firing speakers are covered in a hard fabric mesh. The top firing speakers are hidden beneath a honeycomb grill. The top of the soundbar has a premium metal finish with a brushed metal-like design. The front also has a crisp display giving you information. The remote control is made of plastic, but it does not feel cheap. It provides the basic controls like source selection, volume, sound mode, switch on/off Ambeo surround and power.



PERFORMANCE

Coming to the core performance, sublime, room-filling with clear channel separation is the first thing that will come to mind when you start listening to the Sennheiser Ambeo soundbar. If you have content mastered in Dolby Atmos, be it via the Apple TV, a physical Blu-ray or simply streaming services, you are in for a treat.

In Ready Player One, when the cars were flying all over the screen during the race at the 11-minute mark, the channel and height separation was fantastic. We could not only feel the cars whizzing from the left and right but the dynamic range made it feel as though some of the sound was coming from above. It isn't the best nor the perfect representation of Dolby Atmos, but it does give the best Dolby Atmos "feel" from a single bar.

Even in a movie like Mission Impossible: Rogue Nation, when Tom Cruise is whizzing left and right on his motorcycle, there is clear channel separation. Even in Spider-Man Homecoming, when Spider-Man is scaling the Washington Monument, there is clear surround sound and channel shift.

Even watching TV shows like Young Sheldon, or Friends had depth and detail we haven't heard before. The soundbar is truly impressive.

APP

To delve deep into the settings of the Ambeo, you will need the Sennheiser Smart Connect app. For its part, it

works quite well, giving you a simple UI to navigate. It's functional and easy to use and we have only two problems with it. One is that you cannot connect to the Wi-Fi directly and need to resort to a third-party app like Google Home and secondly, every time you navigate away from the app, and reopen it, it takes a couple of seconds to find the soundbar.

VERDICT

The Sennheiser Ambeo is a great soundbar. It can produce room-filling immersive sound and packs a theatre-like punch with good channel separation. The overall experience from the bar for watching movies and gaming is superior to a lot of soundbars we've tested simply because of the quality of sound output. The music output is good too. It also comes with ample connectivity options. If you are in the market for a premium plug-and-play home theatre solution, you can definitely consider the Sennheiser Ambeo.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

NUMBER OF CHANNELS: 5.1.4 | SPEAKER TYPE: 6x 4" longthrow woofer, cellulose sandwich cone, 5x 1" tweeter, aluminium dome tweeter, 2x 3.5" fullrange driver (top-firing) | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 30 Hz to 20 kHz | Weight: approx 18.5 kg | DISPLAY: Graphic OLED with brightness sensor, status LED, AMBEO LED | APP SUPPORT: Sennheiser Smart Control App | INPUTS: 3x HDMI In (v2.0a), 1x HDMI Out (v2.1 eARC), 1x Optical In, 1x AUX In (Stereo RCA), 1x USB (for Service/Update), 1x Ethernet, 1x Subwoofer Pre-Out (Mono-RCA, max 2V), 1x Mic Input (2.5mm jack), Bluetooth, Google Chromecast, Media (UPnP) | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 4.2, class 1, BR/EDR, BLE Supported Bluetooth codecs: AAC, SBC

CONTACT

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